Application area	Drone model/ example	Country of use	Purpose/ mission role	Key features/ technology used	Significa contribu
			over pre-set distances.		modern cruise missiles.
Experimental combat simulation	*Ruston Proctor Aerial Target (1917)*	United Kingdom	Tested remote operation and control accuracy under combat-like conditions.	Early radio-guided control surfaces; piston engine propulsion.	Demonst feasibilit remotely operated combat aircraft.
Military research and technological development	Various prototypes (1916–1939)	United Kingdom and United States	Conducted as research tools for studying aerodynamics, propulsion, and control mechanisms.	Integration of servo linkages, control actuators, and analog radio systems.	Provided experime data advance aviation engineer and co theory.

2.5.1 Target practice and gunnery training

The most prominent military use of first-generation drones was for anti-aircraft gunnery and pilot training. These drones served as moving aerial targets, allowing soldiers to practice shooting at dynamic airborne objects